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The Voters Who Stayed Home: How the NNP Lost St. Andrew North East

The NNP held St. Andrew North East in 2008 and again in 2022. In 2026 it lost by 320 votes, and not principally to switchers: the register grew by 647, yet only six more people voted, and the NNP's own vote fell by 339.

BY GREG HOSTEN ST. ANDREW NORTH EAST, GRENADA

ST. ANDREW NORTH EAST, GRENADA— St. Andrew North East, which runs from Pearls and La Poterie through Belair, Tivoli and Upper St. John to Paraclete, has been one of the NNP's most dependable seats. Roland Bhola held it in 2008, when the NDC won 11 seats; Kate Lewis-Peters won it in 2018 and held it in 2022, by 2,190 votes to 1,864, even as her party lost power.

> **"If the NNP had simply kept its 2022 voters, it would have won."**
> GREG HOSTEN

On 5th November she lost it. The NDC's Niecal Joseph took 2,171 votes to Ms. Lewis-Peters's 1,851, with 45 for the DPM's Pamela Williams. An NNP majority of 326 four years ago had become a deficit of 320.

A SITTING MEMBER, DEFEATED

This was not a seat lost by a newcomer. Ms. Lewis-Peters, a former secondary school teacher from St. Andrew, had been the member for eight years and a minister in the last NNP government, and after the December 2024 convention she became the party's Assistant General Secretary. In January 2025, after Peter David left the NNP, she was obliged to state publicly that she had not resigned from the party.

An incumbent with that profile ought to be the hardest kind of candidate to beat. Yet her vote fell by 339 while the NDC's rose by only 307, and that gap is the story of St. Andrew North East.

THE NNP'S VOTERS DID NOT SWITCH. THEY STAYED HOME.

The striking figure is this. Between 2022 and 2026 the register in St. Andrew North East grew by 647 names, from 5,362 to 6,009, yet the number of ballots cast rose by just six, from 4,071 to 4,077. Turnout fell from 75.9 per cent, one of the highest in the country, to 67.8 per cent.

The NNP lost 339 votes and the NDC gained 307. Even if every one of the NDC's new votes came from former NNP voters, at least 32 of the NNP's 2022 supporters voted for nobody, and the more plausible reading is larger still: with almost no change in total ballots, a substantial part of the NNP's 2022 vote simply did not come out.

That is a different defeat from the one next door in St. Andrew South East, where the NNP held its vote and the NDC found new voters. Here the NNP's own supporters drifted away, and the number of registered voters who did not vote rose from 1,291 to 1,932.

BETTER THAN THE NATIONAL SWING, NOT GOOD ENOUGH

Measured as a share of the two-party vote, the NNP fell from 54.0 per cent to 46.0 per cent, a drop of 8.0 points, against a national decline of 10.3 points. Ms. Lewis-Peters thus ran more than two points ahead of her party's decline, which speaks to her personal standing.

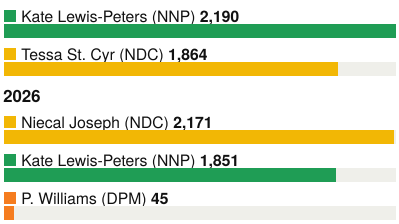
A majority of 326, however, could not absorb even an eight-point swing. Seats of this kind, held in 2022 by a few hundred votes, required more than a better-than-average result. They required growth, and there was none.

PEARLS AND LA POTERIE HELD. THE MIDDLE DID NOT.

The polling-division returns show a seat divided in two. The NNP carried 5 of the 15 divisions, its strength lying in the north: at the Pearls road office it won one division by 175 votes to 114, and it took 54 per cent at Camp Raymond. At La Poterie it won 54.3 per cent across two divisions, including one by a single vote, 107 to 106.

2022 VS 2026

Votes by candidate, in party colours



320 votes
NDC winning margin in 2026

BY THE NUMBERS

320
NDC winning margin, after an NNP majority of 326 in 2022

+6
Extra ballots cast, while the register grew by 647

–339
Fall in the NNP vote since 2022

5 of 15
Polling divisions won by the NNP

The NDC won the middle and south of the constituency, and won them clearly. At Tivoli it took 490 votes to 333 across three divisions, and at Belair 459 to 318. At Paraclete the NNP won only 36 per cent, and at Upper St. John 42 per cent.

The Grenada Christian Academy was split: the NNP won its larger division by 195 to 182 and lost the other by 168 to 127. The DPM's 45 votes were concentrated at La Poterie, where it took 19, in the NNP's best area.

A QUIET COLLAPSE IN TURNOUT

The fall in turnout deserves particular attention. In 2022 St. Andrew North East recorded one of the highest turnouts in Grenada; in 2026 it was close to the national average. Of all the seats the NNP lost, this one shows most clearly a party that failed to bring its own people to the polls.

Several explanations are possible: a short campaign, a national mood that discouraged opposition supporters, or a branch that had not kept in regular contact with its voters between elections. The numbers cannot say which. They do, however, show where the votes went: not to the NDC, but to the sofa.

ONE HUNDRED AND SIXTY-ONE VOTERS

To have held the seat, the NNP needed 161 voters to switch sides, or 321 more of its own supporters to turn out. The latter is about one in six of the 1,932 who stayed home, and fewer than the 339 votes the NNP has lost since 2022.

Put simply, had the NNP kept its 2022 voters and done nothing else, it would have won. That makes St. Andrew North East a turnout seat first and a persuasion seat second.

WHAT CAN BE DONE: A FOUR-YEAR PLAN FOR THE NORTH-EAST

St. Andrew North East needs a new message less than it needs a party that stays in touch with the people who already voted for it.

Year one, 2027: decide early whether Ms. Lewis-Peters will stand again, and announce the candidate publicly. Rebuild the household list from the 2022 NNP vote, division by division, and contact every household on it within the year. Keep a permanent office open between elections.

Year two, 2028: concentrate on Tivoli and Belair, where the NDC won about 60 per cent across six divisions. Hold regular meetings with farmers, transport operators and young families there, and build a short local programme from what they say. Register new voters every month: the register grew by 647, and very few of them voted.

Year three, 2029: recruit a captain for each of the 15 divisions and give each a turnout target based on its 2022 NNP vote. Protect the strongholds at Pearls and La Poterie, and win back the Grenada Christian Academy division lost by 41 votes.

Year four, 2030: run the campaign as a turnout operation, with transport, reminders and polling-day follow-up for every known supporter. The target is simple: restore the 2022 NNP vote of 2,190, which alone would have won the seat in 2026.

THE LESSON FOR EVERY NNP SEAT

Losing voters to the other side is one kind of defeat; losing them to the sofa is another, and the more dangerous because it is quieter. St. Andrew North East had a sitting member, a known name and a long NNP history, and it still fell, because the party's own supporters did not turn out.

Every NNP seat should maintain a live list of the people who voted for it last time, and contact them between elections rather than only during the campaign. In St. Andrew North East that alone would have been enough.

THE ARITHMETIC OF ST. ANDREW NORTH EAST

Measure	2022	2026	Change
NNP votes	2,190	1,851	−339
NDC votes	1,864	2,171	+307
NNP share of two-party vote	54.0%	46.0%	−8.0 pts
NNP two-party share nationally	48.0%	37.7%	−10.3 pts
Winning margin	NNP +326	NDC +320	646-vote swing
Registered voters	5,362	6,009	+647
Ballots cast	4,071	4,077	+6
Turnout	75.9%	67.8%	−8.1 pts
Registered voters who did not vote	1,291	1,932	+641
NNP votes as a share of all registered voters	40.8%	30.8%	−10.0 pts
Polling divisions won by the NNP		5 of 15	
Switchers the NNP needed to win		161	

Two-party figures exclude minor candidates (2022: IFP 10; 2026: DPM 45). 2026 figures are provisional results from the Parliamentary Elections Office, all 15 polling divisions verified.

WHAT IT MEANS FOR 2030/31

1. Keep your own voters: the NNP lost 339, more than the 320-vote margin.
2. Keep a live list of past supporters and contact them between elections.
3. Watch turnout: it fell eight points while the register grew by 647.
4. An incumbent's personal vote softens a swing but cannot stop it alone.
5. Win back Tivoli and Belair, where the NDC took about 60 per cent.
6. Protect Pearls and La Poterie, the NNP's best ground.
7. Captain all 15 divisions, with turnout targets from the 2022 vote.
8. Target 161 switchers, or simply restore the 2022 NNP vote of 2,190.

Sources: Parliamentary Elections Office live results, live.elections.gd (2026, provisional; polling divisions read 9 Nov 2026); Wikipedia (2022 and 2008 general elections; Kate Lewis); NOW Grenada (NNP convention, 15 Dec 2024; 'MP Lewis-Peters has not resigned from NNP', 21 Jan 2025; 2026 results). Analytics computed by the author from the published counts. Analysis by Greg Hosten, Vol. 5 of a weekly constituency series. Written in the style of a newspaper report; not a publication of any news organisation.